



Some Facts About Sanjay Gupta

Favourite Food: Kadi chawal

Cars or Bikes: Cars

Favourite Car Brand: BMW

Favourite Actress: Madhuri Dixit

Favourite Actor: Akshay Kumar

Favourite Singer: Kishore Kumar, Arijit Singh

Favourite Holiday Destination: Switzerland

Best Friend: Every friend should be a best friend

Favourite Gadget: Smartphones

Favourite Drink: Shikanji, Masala Buttermilk

Favourite Sport: Cricket

Favourite Cricketer: Virat Kohli, Rahul Dravid

Favourite Book: "Good to Great" by Jim Collins

knew I would have to wear different hats," he recalls.

Gupta approached this problem with a creative mindset. He asked the HR team of the group to share resumes that had been rejected by other verticals, and from those he built a team of 14.

"These were the candidates that no other leader in the group wanted. I said to myself that hiring them should not be a problem for anyone," he shares. As the team began making a significant impact, the need for expansion arose. However, Gupta did not want to see himself or the team he had built land in the same situation he faced while initially building the team.

His found solution in off-campus drives. Gupta says, he was able to hire some of the best people he has ever worked with in his professional career. But how did the team create such an impact that it was allowed to expand? The answer—Sad, Mad, Glad!

As a mandatory practice for all his team members in the new vertical, everyone had to write about what they were sad about, mad about, and glad about. These three things were done every quarter. The 'sad about' represented things an individual was unhappy about

and areas that needed improvement. The 'mad about' represented things that were hindering individuals from performing at their best. The 'glad about' represented what they loved about the project and the aspects they enjoyed the most.

"Many might follow this approach across the globe, but our approach was different because we ensured that every aspect of this was addressed every single time," Gupta explains. The Sad, Mad, Glad approach at the group became so fruitful that Gupta was requested to

conduct the same exercise for the entire group every quarter.

For the record, Gupta moved from Duet Technologies when Motorola acquired it. Motorola then spun off Freescale Semiconductor to focus on the automotive, embedded, and communications markets in 2004. In 2015, NXP Semiconductor and Freescale signed an agreement to merge. Technically, Gupta never resigned and was still in his first job, one that he started right after college.

Building a global MNC from India

Since November 2022, probably a month or two after Gupta resigned from his first-ever job, he has been busy building an MNC that aims to represent India's automotive prowess on the global scale. Assigned the role of President and CEO at Spark Minda, there are various aspects he is working on, which cannot be shared here as they are part of the core strategy of the Minda Group. One thing to note here is that Gupta's love for automotive remains intact.

"At NXP, we started many projects for startups and women. I thought of these after my daughter won a Google scholarship. These initiatives led me to take an active

part in various government ministries as well as associations like IESA. I believe this is where the leadership of the Minda Group identified me as a leader. I never wanted to leave my first job behind, but this was an opportunity to put India on the global map. I just couldn't say no," he says.

At the same time, he is proud that engineers from countries like Germany, China, and the United States are reporting to the team he built. "From being used to reporting to managers sitting outside India, to having those managers report to teams in India, is one of the best feelings in the world," he says.

However, that wasn't enough, and he said to himself, "Why not build a company that can help automotive giants around the world in innovation and technology?" He said yes to Spark Minda!

Gupta credits all his achievements to his wife, parents, and children. He says his fortune turned around when he tied the knot. "She has taken care of the family in my absence. I still reach home late, but her love for me has not changed but only increased. I am blessed to have her in my life," he says with a lot of love and pride.

And, what's the most romantic thing he has ever done for his wife? An international vacation is planned every alternate year, if not every year, for the couple! Moreover, he made sure his parents visited the *char dham* in their prime, so they could enjoy each of them! Gupta's son is preparing for IIT JEE exams, while his daughter is in her final year of engineering at the same college Gupta studied.

"Only a human can beat him/herself. No one can defeat you unless you say you have lost. Every time you go through a setback, get yourself up, and walk ahead," he concludes. **EFY**